



RESEARCH / PROJECT ETHICS REVIEW FORM
For Thesis / Capstone / Dissertation Proposals
(ver.Oct2024c)

Names of Student Researcher(s):

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Research/Thesis/Capstone Title: Socius: A Chatbot focused on training Pragmatic Competence assessed through Grice's Maxims and Implicatures

College: College of Computer Studies

Department: Software Technology

Course: THS-ST1

Expected Duration of the Project: from: AY 2025-2026 Term 1 to: AY 2025-2026 Term 2

PROTOCOL:

(To be filled up by proponents; Use the Ethics Checklists as guides in determining areas for ethical concern/consideration. Attach and properly reference the accomplished ethics checklists and supporting documents.)

		Reference Document (include page number)
Target participants	Young adults aged 15-24	Ethics Checklist A, Paper Page 7
Data to be used / collected	GRICE Dataset for conversational examples utilizing implicatures from pragmatics. Collection of conversation logs to track user progress in pragmatic competence. User profile info (email, username, password) for basic user storage.	Paper page 27 (user profile) Paper pages 35-36 (Grice)
Brief procedure	Users will converse with the chatbot through emulated social contexts, then will receive feedback after conversations. The chat logs will then be stored in order for the AI to assess where the user would need to improve in terms of their social communication ability, specifically pragmatics.	Paper page 7
Potential risks	Given the delicate nature of mental health and social awkwardness for some, there is the possibility of the chatbot providing hurtful, overly critical responses. The chatbot may also provide counter productive feedback, leaving the users	Informed Consent Form - Page 3

	with less pragmatic competence than they began with. Gemini may memorize the pattern of the chatlogs, meaning the LLM may train itself on the user's conversations.	
Applicable Terms of Use or Licensing Agreement of Data, Models and/or Tools	The GRICE dataset (Zheng et al., 2021), used in this research, is publicly available and was released as part of the <i>Findings of ACL-IJCNLP 2021</i> . It is © 2021 Association for Computational Linguistics. The dataset is used here strictly for academic and non-commercial research purposes, in accordance with ACL's standard terms of use. No modifications or redistribution of the dataset are performed in this study.	
Steps to safeguard the participants and/or data	The personal information stored in the database will be obscured when presented in the paper, thereby using fake names and emails when required in a figure. Moreover, the conversation logs and personal information will not be used outside of the study.	Informed Consent Form - Page 3
Other concerns and considerations		
PANEL'S ASSESSMENT/COMMENTS: 		
PANEL'S DECISION: € Approved (<i>Proponent/s may proceed with the study/data collection</i>) € Modifications Required (<i>Proponent/s should address ethical issues, follow the panel's recommendations for required modifications, and resubmit Ethics Review Form for approval before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection</i>) € For Full Review (<i>Proponent/s should submit the proposal to the University Research Ethics Review Committee (RERC) and obtain a research ethics clearance before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection</i>)		
JUSTIFICATION:		

Name and Signature of Adviser/Mentor
Date:

Name and Signature of Panel Member
Date:

Name and Signature of Panel Member
Date:

Name and Signature of Panel Member
Date: